involved sending lightly armed Pakistani troops disguised as locals into the Kashmir Valley. Once in the valley the troops were expected to link up with Pakistani sympathizers and foment a rebellion. Taking advantage of these disturbed conditions the Pakistan Army would then launch a full-scale assault on the valley, seizing it in a series of quick incursions. The plan, of course, was acutely dependent on the ability of the initial infiltrators and the local Pakistani sympathizers to wreak sufficient havoc and create conducive conditions for the invasion.[21]

The infiltration began along the 470-mile cease-fire line in Kashmir around August 5, 1965. The intruders carried small arms, hand grenades, plastic explosives, and radio equipment. Much to the dismay of the Pakistani military and political leadership, however, the local population did not support the infiltrators and instead turned them in to the authorities. Despite this loss of surprise, the Pakistanis decided to go ahead with their original war plans. They launched Operation Grand Slam on August 31–September 1 in southern Kashmir. Two infantry divisions spearheaded by seventy tanks constituted the Pakistani strike force. The Pakistanis hoped to capture the town of Akhnur, which would have enabled them to cut off the state of Jammu and Kashmir from the rest of India. In response, India escalated horizontally, launching a powerful attack directed against the Pakistani city of Lahore on September 6. Simultaneously, they also launched an offensive toward the town of Sialkot, a major nexus of roads and railways and a military center in the Punjab. These two coordinated offensives produced the desired result: They forced the Pakistanis to withdraw from Akhnur.

The Indian drive toward Lahore was initially quite successful, and the military managed to capture a number of villages along the way. In the end, however, the Indians were unable to assault Lahore directly, as the Pakistanis had destroyed the bridges across the Ichogil irrigation canal on the outskirts of the city. Similarly, the Indian effort to capture Sialkot failed in the wake of several inconclusive battles. Toward mid-September the war was reaching a stalemate. On September 20, the UN Security Council passed a unanimous resolution calling for a cease-fire. India accepted the cease-fire resolution on September 21 and Pakistan on September 22. Under